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# Base44: A One-Person AI Company Picks a Path

*We love what you're doing. How can we help?*

— Avishai Abrahami, Wix CEO and co-founder

In April 2025, Base44 founder Maor Shlomo walked into the Tel Aviv, Israel, office of Wix CEO Avishai Abrahami, who warmly opened their first meeting and laid out the options for a partnership.

Shlomo had used artificial intelligence (AI) to build a platform that could turn plain-language user prompts into fully functioning software applications (apps). The concept was not new; startups including Replit, Lovable, and Bolt were raising tens of millions of dollars from venture capitalists (VCs) by allowing non-technical customers to create apps for personal use or profit.[1] Base44 was unique in that it handled back-end support directly, making both app creation and deployment seamless.[a]

Several months after founding Base44 early in the year, Shlomo had still not hired any employees or raised any money. He used AI tools he built himself to help with coding, marketing, and support, leveraging automated processes to turn Base44 into one of the fastest-growing companies in history.

Shlomo documented his journey transparently on social media, sharing highlights—massive growth and exciting user projects—as well as lowlights—the struggles of being a solopreneur and complex technical challenges. Although investors clamored to get a piece of Base44, the founder was reluctant to accept funding. "Almost every VC firm in Israel and many U.S. firms reached out," he said. "I told them it was nothing personal, I just had more positive energy not risking money that wasn't mine." However, Shlomo admired Wix, a public company helping users design and host websites since its founding in 2006. Shlomo wanted to meet Abrahami, a respected CEO and leader, and get his advice.

Over the course of several subsequent meetings, they discussed Base44's options. Base44 could stay independent by raising capital to scale. Shlomo could sell the company; Abrahami's interest was clear.

[a] Back-end support referred to the infrastructure and services that ran behind the scenes of an application—such as servers, databases, authentication, and integrations—that handled data processing, storage, and scalability.

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A third possibility was a joint venture or strategic partnership that would allow Shlomo to continue to run Base44 but with leveraged marketing and distribution. What was this solopreneur's best option?

## Maor Shlomo

Shlomo grew up in Haifa, in northern Israel. He recalled, "I have severe ADHD [attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder], so school was hard, even though I had great talent for math and computer science." He continued, "There are two things I love: programming and painting. You have something in your head, you move your hands a bit, and then your idea becomes reality." He also joined the Scouts, a popular outdoor activity-focused youth group, starting a lifelong volunteer relationship with the organization.

As a young adult, Shlomo was not initially drawn to technology as a field in itself. That began to change through hands-on project work, where, as he put it, "I saw how technology can be really valuable and useful," and he discovered his love of programming.

In 2017, Shlomo turned down admittance to the prestigious Israeli university Technion to found a data science startup; he served as CEO and his co-founders served as chief operating officer and chief technical officer. Their product integrated a company's internal data with external sources to power predictive machine learning models. By 2021, the company had raised $127 million, employed 130 people, and had offices in Tel Aviv and California.[2]

### *The Israeli Tech Ecosystem*

Per capita, Israel had the highest number of startups and the highest number of tech unicorns—companies valued at $1 billion or more—in the world.[3] In 2024, Israeli tech startups raised $12.5 billion, one of the highest rates globally.[4]

Observers noted several reasons why Israel became a startup hub. It was an extremely well-educated country; more than half its citizens held a college degree.[5] Mandatory military service and large government investments in military research and development meant many Israelis had high levels of technical training; elite intelligence units functioned as accelerated schools for cybersecurity, data analysis, and systems thinking.[6] Personal networks from those units reduced friction for forming teams, raising the trust level among founders.

Because the domestic market was relatively small, the tech sector was tight-knit, and founders and CEOs often knew each other. Israeli startups usually had a "scale abroad" business model: they designed from day one for the larger global market. As a result, go-to-market strategies were internationally focused by default. Founders often set up U.S. offices early and built global distribution faster than their peers in other countries. This combination of global focus and sought-after skills meant Israeli companies were represented well on the world stage; for example, Israeli companies were responsible for around 40% of global cybersecurity sales.[7]

Observers also pointed to intangible cultural factors, such as direct communication, comfort with uncertainty, and a willingness to question authority, all of which made it relatively easy for founders to challenge assumptions and iterate. Founders typically grew up in a society where ambiguity and adversity were part of daily life. This produced a psychological profile that tolerated risk in high-pressure environments, allowing quick pivots after failures.[8]



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### *Pivoting to Generative AI*

In late 2022, Shlomo noticed a change in the market. He said, "ChatGPT released and almost overnight, every piece of attention from our champions and our buyers switched from predictive models to LLMs."[b] Chief data officers or VPs of technology in companies across industries increasingly focused on generative AI (genAI) tools, thinking that AI-powered technology could replace or enhance most software, including predictive models. Shlomo recalled thinking, "This is not a storm that will pass through—we have to change what we do entirely."

Shlomo convinced his co-founders and board to integrate AI into a new version of the company's platform, but he encountered difficulties shifting focus. He said,

> We needed to iterate fast and work hard, but every time I would try to make changes from the CEO position, I would need to go all the way down past my middle management, to say, 'This button needs to move' or 'I need to talk to this user.' People wanted me to get back to high-level stuff like creating key performance indicators, but I thought I needed to be in founder mode.

That year, he gave his CEO seat to one of his co-founders and focused on coding. He explained his logic in getting hands-on:

> You hire people to build on top of an idea, or a sketch. If you're Antoni Gaudí[c] and you've designed a church, you might have very talented people under you to help you build that church. But if you decide it shouldn't be a church anymore, that the design should be completely different, those people might not be able to help make that switch, even if they were the best people to build that first idea.
>
> If my employees were able to crack the market for a company that raised $127 million, knew how to pivot and generate revenue really fast, and knew how to sell that, probably they wouldn't be working for me. They would start their own companies. People might be perfect for their roles, but if they could come up with the design for the whole company, they wouldn't be director of product. They'd be a founder.

## Founding Base44

In Shlomo's spare time, he resumed coding and got first-hand experience with AI: "In my years as CEO of a software company, there was one approach—the more engineers you throw at a problem, the faster it gets solved. Now, people who leverage AI are moving faster than teams of 10, 20, 50. Everything is changing," he realized. "If I don't try anything in this new world of AI, I'm going to regret it."

In October 2023, Shlomo had to step away from his company for approximately a year. During that time, his co-founder took their company in a direction he did not agree with. He said, "When we made the CEO switch, I stayed on the board, but I said, 'I will never vote against my co-founder.' I kept this

[b] Large language models (LLMs) were AI systems trained on massive amounts of text and other data; OpenAI's ChatGPT, an LLM chatbot released in November 2022, could coherently hold conversations and generate content for users.

[c] A Spanish architect most famous for the Sagrada Família church in Barcelona, Spain, which started construction in 1882 and was still incomplete as of 2025.



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promise, but I was not in full agreement with the new direction. I thought it was probably best if I didn't tear the company apart with everyone pushing for their own direction."

Shlomo looked for a new project. He said, "As a software entrepreneur, there is nothing more interesting than software that builds software." Two things prompted him to pursue this seriously. His soon-to-be wife wanted a website with customer relationship tools to manage her art studio business. Shlomo tried to help: "I tried to do it with no-code systems, but it didn't make sense. I knew that LLMs could do this." He was also volunteering with the Scouts, who were trying to update several back-office systems. Shlomo said, "They had zero software engineers or developers. Every time they needed something new, a software company would quote them a few million dollars that they didn't have."

## *Vibe Coding*

OpenAI's November 2022 release of ChatGPT had started a race to build advanced genAI.[9] OpenAI and competitors such as Anthropic and Google developed more powerful foundation models with wide-ranging applications. Other companies developed software that used those models for specific purposes, including coding software. Early entrants, such as Cursor and Microsoft's Copilot, integrated with coding tools that professional developers already used; they scanned a user's code and offered suggestions to complete a line or fix bugs. Previously, some companies, such as Bubble, Salesforce, and Trello, had offered drag-and-drop functionality to allow non-technical users to create apps of various levels of complexity; these "no-code" or "low-code" apps also began integrating AI into their products.

By 2025, AI models had advanced such that users could use plain-language prompts to generate code even if they had no understanding of the underlying mechanics; an OpenAI co-founder dubbed this "vibe coding." As AI models improved, numerous startups began offering easy-to-use software building products (see **Exhibit 1**).[10] "Founders of code-gen startups and their investors believe they are in a land grab situation, with a shrinking window to gain a critical mass of users and establish their AI coding tool as the industry standard," one observer wrote in early 2025.[11]

As Shlomo tried out numerous no-code and vibe coding platforms, he found them lacking. He envisioned creating his own platform that would allow non-technical users to make more complex applications. He theorized that automatically including back-end functions such as authentication and analytics might solve some of the problems with competitors. Shlomo said:

> If the company was built pre-2022, usually they have a problem. My girlfriend or the Scouts could not operate these tools. You need to know about databases and integrating APIs and such. Replit, Lovable, Bubble, and the rest were either too technical or needed an understanding of software and product that non-technical people did not understand.
>
> LLMs allow for a completely different interface. Pre-2022, you always had this tension between ease of use and customization. With Salesforce you can make anything you want, but to implement it you need a Salesforce implementer. Then you have Monday.com, which is simpler but still customized. Then with Trello, no setup is necessary, but it is not customizable. LLMs took that entire axis and wiped it all out. Now you can build very complex things with very simple processes.

## *Early Experimentation*

Near the end of October 2024, Shlomo started building the Base44 platform, inspired by the mission itself like never before. He said, "Base44 felt different. It's so much easier to power through all the tough times as an entrepreneur when you are excited about what you're doing."



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Shlomo convinced three unemployed non-technical friends to try to build a software-as-a-service (SaaS) application using Base44. They met every three days; Shlomo looked over their shoulders as they got stuck due to software bugs or misunderstandings so he could immediately fix issues. He thought, "If those three can build something, I have something on my hands."

By January 2025, two of the three early users had built working applications, and Shlomo decided he would seriously pursue Base44 as a business. He had also shared it with a wider circle of friends, and even though he viewed the product as "completely broken," his initial users were willing to suffer through its bugs and quirks because they were getting promising early results.

## *Building the Product*

Shlomo used several tools and applications to help him efficiently manage the business and build Base44 (see **Exhibit 2a** for his tech stack). He said, "I knew if I was going to do this alone, I had to leverage AI in the fullest way. Otherwise, I would not be able to keep up with the competition."

Shlomo used Cursor to help him code the back-end functions of Base44. He used Base44 itself to create tools that helped him further develop the front-end. He said, "AI works much better with smaller chunks of code, instead of trying to do everything end-to-end. That insight helped me code Base44 but also helped me implement the coding agent for Base44 to help users." Shlomo trained Cursor by iterating on the prompts he gave it. He said, "Every time it made a mistake, I not only fixed it for the thing I was making, but fixed it for the next time, so I could do it in one prompt instead of two. It got so optimized that it had rules for everything."

Without guidance, the foundational model—Base44 used Anthropic's Claude—would create unintuitive user interfaces and unsightly colors. Shlomo said, "I also trained myself on how to prompt. Every time I wrote code I added rules—'Make it super clean, elegant, and modern, not too colorful.'" Shlomo added much of what he learned about creating a good prompt to the built-in instructions hidden from Base44 users, effectively adding instructions to every user's prompts to make sure Base44 returned results in line with what they expected, even if they did not specifically request it.

As he built the main Base44 platform, Shlomo used it to create productivity tools and automated processes to help him handle his growing user base. He created tools to write marketing content, to manage credits and refunds, and to answer technical support questions. He said, "I built those inside Base44, which helped me be the user and the builder."

Shlomo concentrated much of his effort on ensuring that Base44 could automatically handle back-end processes for user applications. Depending on its capabilities and complexity, an app deployment might involve connecting to a database, handling APIs to interact with other applications, and finding a server to host it. As an app scaled, it might require additional data storage, security updates, or other maintenance. Other vibe coding platforms provided the code at the core of the app, but a user would still need to manually hook the code up to all the back-end processes that made it work. Shlomo made choices on behalf of the user—what vendor to use for database support, for example—allowing the platform to automatically handle back-end processes behind the scenes. Even technical users could otherwise spend significant time on back-end processes to deploy an app; grateful testers called Base44's method the "batteries included" approach.

## *Traction*

In January 2025, Base44 officially launched. Users paid for a certain number of credits, or interactions, per month, with more complex projects requiring a higher subscription level. The typical



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entry price was $20 per month billed annually. Within a month, Base44 went from zero to over $1 million in annual recurring revenue (ARR).

Shlomo had sporadically posted about Base44 on social media. In February 2025, he began a more intentional strategy, posting about the platform on business networking site LinkedIn for the first time (see **Exhibit 2b**). He had been disappointed with his prior marketing efforts, including paying an influencer $2,000 for a post. Shlomo said, "Posting on LinkedIn was cheap and sparked a lot of interest in my target audience, who are builders themselves. I decided I was going to tell my story about building a company to people who want to build a company." The posts attracted users. In early March 2025, Base44 surpassed 20,000 users (see **Exhibit 2c**). In late March, it surpassed 100,000 users.

Base44's success, Shlomo thought, was partly due to the public perception he fostered of a fast-growing company. On a podcast, he explained his reasoning:

> Velocity is a growth engine. [. . .] People really like to see charts, and they like to see numbers. It gets them attached to this product if they are saying, 'I wonder what's going to be [profitable] next week,' or 'I wonder how much money it's losing or how they can optimize'—they get attached to that.
>
> Velocity is to some degree the same thing, because if your product evolves really fast and you're putting features out there every other day, people get attached to that. [. . .] I remember people commenting on my posts saying, 'You know what, it's moving so fast, I have to try it now.' [. . .] [Velocity]'s going to solve every product problem we have—or most of them—it's going to solve your marketing challenges if you're smart about it and you're putting the content out there and you're making everything a community launch.[12]

Other vibe coding startups that focused on growth relied on VC funding to subsidize operations. Replit had raised $222 million since its 2016 founding, including nearly $120 million in 2023.[13] Bolt had raised $982 million since 2016, including $355 million in 2022.[14] Much of the funding paid for the high costs of foundation models such as those released by Anthropic and OpenAI. Every request an app made of an LLM cost money, and coding apps like Base44 typically sent many requests over the course of a software project. One expert noted, "Margins on all of the 'code gen' products are either neutral or negative. They're absolutely abysmal."[15]

As a bootstrapped company, Base44 had a different approach. "My challenge, unlike competitors, was to stay very profitable because I had no funding," Shlomo noted. "I constantly knew, at any given point, that I could increase my margins if I made adjustments to the product or pricing to focus on optimizing costs. But I was also focused on growth. I was always on the verge of being very profitable, and then I released growth-oriented features that increased costs, and then I would optimize again."

By May 2025, Shlomo began to see strong enterprise adoption; he had 1,300 paid enterprise accounts and planned to introduce a new business tier (see **Exhibit 2d**). He began hearing stories about startups that raised funding for products built using Base44. He had expected to make $100,000 in profit in May, but business uptake had increased faster than he thought and improvements Anthropic made to Claude cut his costs; as the model made fewer mistakes, users needed to call on the LLM to fix them less frequently (see **Exhibit 3**). He ended up recording nearly $200,000 in profit that month.

As Shlomo contemplated the next phase of Base44's growth, he received a meeting invitation from Wix. Based on Abrahami's reputation as someone with good advice for fellow entrepreneurs and a successful "scale up" founder who had led his company end-to-end from inception to an initial public



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offering (IPO) and a market capitalization of over $5 billion, Shlomo accepted the invitation and met with the CEO and some top Wix executives in April 2025.

## Wix

Wix was founded in 2006 in Tel Aviv by Avishai Abrahami, Nadav Abrahami, and Giora Kaplan, and quickly established itself as an easy, drag-and-drop website builder for non-technical users, providing a cloud-based web development platform through a freemium model. Wix reported 6.7 million users in 2010 and 17.2 million in 2011. In 2013, Wix raised $127 million in an IPO that valued the company at $600 million. Through the mid-2010s, the company expanded its product portfolio organically and through small acquisitions to serve increasingly sophisticated small-business needs.

The COVID-19 pandemic was a major inflection point for the company. As small businesses and individuals rushed to establish an online presence in 2020, Wix's revenue grew to $984 million, up 30% year-over-year. By 2023, Wix reported 263 million registered users and 6.3 million premium subscriptions, with annual revenue of $1.56 billion.

### *Product Development and Culture of Innovation*

Over the years, Wix had to constantly innovate and adapt to market shifts. For example, the company's first editor, built on Adobe Flash, was replaced in 2012 by an HTML5 editor when Apple announced they would no longer support Flash in its iOS operating system. That same year, Wix introduced its App Market and software development kits (SDKs), moving from building everything in-house to creating an open platform for third parties to extend the product.

Wix's 5,300 employees had a "companies and guilds" structure. In this model, cross-functional "companies" owned specific product areas or customer journeys, while "guilds" connected people in the same discipline, such as design or engineering, across different product groups to share standards and expertise. Abrahami explained,

> We're pretty good at innovation. You take the team, you let them run independently, you give them support—someone really senior works with them, so they are allowed to break the rules, although we do require they work our way in regards to product, UX [user experience], and marketing. Then, when they create something, we stop and see if we can make it into something real.

Wix continued to innovate with the launch of Wix ADI (Artificial Design Intelligence) in 2016, one of the earliest AI-driven website builders, which generated custom layouts and content from a short user questionnaire. Abrahami recalled, "It worked on algorithms that were very naïve and basic compared to what you have today."

Abrahami recognized the potential of genAI early: "The first time I understood what LLMs can do was when the team showed me how to use prompts to create small components in a website—they built a calculator, super small, but it worked. I was blown away. I went home and couldn't sleep. I thought, 'Oh my God, this is going to change so much.'" He vowed, "In the next version of Wix, we will be using a lot of these AI capabilities. You will be able to build incredible things in your website."

In March 2024, Wix rolled out an AI website-building chatbot to the public, allowing users to describe their business in natural language and receive a complete, editable site in return. In 2024 and 2025, Wix introduced a suite of genAI tools that could—for example—write full blog posts, and a business assistant and marketing assistant within the Wix ecosystem. Still, Abrahami thought Wix



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could do more. He said, "You can't build a good website on vibe coding platforms. It's hard to update, and every time you change something, something else will break, and ensuring proper data protection often needs extra attention."

As vibe coding tools started gaining traction, internal questions at Wix emerged regarding whether the company should participate in the space and perhaps build its own tool. When he first heard of Base44, Abrahami was impressed with Shlomo's focus on going beyond only producing code to incorporate things non-technical users might not have realized they needed. He said, "Anyone can build a vibe coding company. To do it in a coherent way is a big deal. It was an amazing product." He asked his team to set up a meeting with Shlomo.

### *Meeting with Base44*

When they met, Abrahami recalled thinking Shlomo looked exhausted: "He was working very hard operating a one-person company." As they talked, Abrahami decided that he liked Shlomo's thought process: "He really understands the user experience and the intent of the user. He has incredible drive, and for me that is the most important part. The reason I get up and go to work is not because I need money. It's passion. I have made enough money in my life." He sensed a kindred spirit in Shlomo: "I asked him, what do you want from this?' He said, 'I don't care about the money. I know I'll make enough money. I want Base44 to be the biggest vibe coding platform in the world.'"

Abrahami gave advice freely. He told Shlomo, "We can be friends, and I'll help you. Wix can invest, maybe acquire. But I'm not going to push any agenda." The approach charmed Shlomo. He said, "I thought the Wix executives would be serious public company businessmen who would just convince me to sell for a small number. But we had great chemistry."

The most important thing to decide, in Abrahami's opinion, was how quickly Base44 needed to scale. Abrahami asked, "What kind of a race do you think you're in? Formula 1 or NASCAR?[d] If you believe that it's a Formula 1 race, it's going to be very hard for you to do it by yourself."

## Options

### *Fundraise and Stay Independent*

As an engineer, Shlomo thought about his decision in terms of what he would be optimizing. Optimizing for fun, he thought, meant staying solo. Shlomo said, "I could just keep doing what I love. Business was going nicely, and my day-to-day was never more fun. I could just clear out all the noise around me. My competitors were going extremely fast, and I might go slower: they might eat me up, but I could stay at this nice, bootstrapped pace."

If he wanted to stay independent and seriously compete with other vibe coding companies, Shlomo knew he had to raise money. He had plenty of opportunities, as persistent VCs flooded his email inbox with offers to meet. One, a stranger, sent Shlomo a LinkedIn direct message with a signed $1 million

[d] Formula 1 and NASCAR were auto racing leagues. Formula 1 featured cars that were much more expensive, technically advanced, and faster than those in NASCAR.



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SAFE with a 10% discount rate and no valuation cap.[e] Shlomo said, "I stopped answering any calls from unknown numbers. Sometimes I would tell people I was abroad so I could focus."

Though Shlomo saw the logic in taking on investors, he was not sure it was the right time. Base44 was growing extremely fast already, and he had not run into problems scaling by self-funding (see **Exhibit 4**). If he was going to raise money, waiting even a few months might earn Base44 a higher valuation and give Shlomo more leverage when negotiating with investors.

### *Sell (to Wix)*

On the other hand, Shlomo considered optimizing for impact. He believed he had a great product and just needed some support—sales, support staff, and most importantly, marketing. He said, "I thought if I could do this at a global scale, that would be the most fulfilling. What if I optimized for what would get Base44 in the hands of the most users? The company doesn't need to be in my hands."

Shlomo and Abrahami agreed that to grow to the next level, Base44 needed more employees, and thus more corporate structure. Abrahami saw that as a point in favor of selling: "Maor has been a CEO, he knows being a CEO is not fun. He was very unexcited about hiring people. He wanted to do product and technology." Shlomo worried about getting saddled with tasks he did not enjoy, as had happened at his previous company. He said, "I didn't want to get acquired and be a part of a corporate entity."

Shlomo also wondered how much of Base44's success was due to its independence. Like many coders, he was a fan and user of Cursor, a program released in 2023 by startup Anysphere that was a variant of Microsoft's Visual Studio Code IDE. Anysphere grew rapidly, raising $900 million on a $9.9 billion valuation in 2025.[16] Despite intense acquisition interest from larger companies, including OpenAI, the founders publicly stated that they would remain independent for the foreseeable future.[17] Shlomo admired their conviction: "If Cursor was sold to Microsoft early on, it would not have been Cursor. It would have died."

While Shlomo had not seen a company through an exit, the offers he had received gave him confidence to negotiate with Wix as they explored hypothetical acquisition scenarios. Shlomo said, "It turns out that company valuation is way more of an art than I would have figured beforehand." He talked through the tradeoffs: "Base44 grew very fast—$0 to $4 million ARR in two months. But on the other hand, the company was only me. So, they didn't need to put up a large number—pretty much any figure is going to change my life." The offers that Shlomo received varied wildly. He entertained the idea of a variable payout, allowing him to maintain an interest in Base44's future growth if he sold.

### *Partner*

Shlomo said, "Base44 had a fantastic product, and the minute it meets the right marketing team it will blow up." He was convinced that Wix, which he thought had one of the best marketing teams in the industry, was the perfect partner. Shlomo said, "I needed an experienced and aggressive marketing team. I had a short timeframe where my product is better than competitors, but my go-to-market capabilities are absolutely not."

Shlomo explored the idea of a joint venture with Wix in which Wix would invest in Base44, but more importantly, would market the product. He said, "I was getting plenty of offers for investment.

[e] A Simple Agreement for Future Equity (SAFE) was an early-stage startup financing tool. In this case, the investor offered $1 million to receive $1.1 million worth of Base44 shares at the next opportunity (e.g., a fundraising round or public offering). Without a valuation cap, the higher Base44's valuation, the less of the company (percentage-wise) the investor would own.



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But it takes time to hire and build a marketing team, and the market is moving very, very fast." Instead, he envisioned an arrangement similar to Microsoft's investment in OpenAI, in which Microsoft mainly provided access to cloud storage and advanced chips instead of cash in return for a stake in OpenAI.[18] Shlomo and the Wix executives pondered, as he put it, "doing what Microsoft and OpenAI did, but instead of compute, Wix would provide marketing."

## Conclusion

After his initial meeting with Abrahami, Shlomo met with the Wix team several more times to talk about his options and consider hypotheticals. As he left the latest meeting, Shlomo reflected on his journey: "It was very cool that I was able to get product-market fit without funding. It meant I had 100% of the company, and financially that is great, but if I'm not making the right decision here or there, I will get eaten up by aggressive competitors."

Shlomo wanted to make better decisions as a repeat founder. He said, "I was 23 when I started my first company. I was so young and so inexperienced and made so many mistakes: hiring too many people, raising too much money, lack of focus. I went against every piece of advice I got. The company did well, but day-to-day, it felt like we were powering through rather than doing well." Now, six months after starting Base44 and only four months after publicly releasing it, he had to make a decision that could either supercharge or arrest its growth trajectory.

Shlomo thought carefully about Abrahami's question of speed—how much time did he have? Was he more concerned with ensuring he was having fun by being intimately involved in the product, or did he need to accelerate the company's growth to ensure Base44 stayed competitive? What were his options if he valued both? Shlomo thought, "I am in a race. And the competitors around me are moving very fast. Will getting acquired speed me up or slow me down?"



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**Exhibit 1** Vibe Coding Companies, 2025

*Lovable*

Sweden-based Lovable, launched in November 2024, let users build web apps through a conversational interface, supported by a visual editor that enabled drag-and-drop adjustments and editing. The platform targeted non-coders who needed to build prototypes, internal dashboards, or lightweight tools without engineering resources. Lovable did not offer native back-end support, requiring users to integrate external services such as databases, authentication, and file storage. Compared to competitors, Lovable was less customizable at the raw code level due to its abstraction but offered more control than classic no-code tools through its code mode and developer tools.

Lovable grew out of GPT-Engineer, an open-source tool released in mid-2023 that generated full codebases from a single prompt and became very popular on the developer platform GitHub. This early success created a highly engaged community and a waitlist of 27,000 users before Lovable even launched. Lovable reached $4 million in annual recurring revenue (ARR) in its first 30 days, $10 million by December 2024, and $18 million by January 2025 with about 30,000 paying customers. In March 2025, the company operated a team of 15 people.

*Bolt*

Bolt, developed by San Francisco-based StackBlitz and launched in October 2024, was an AI-powered builder for websites, web apps, and mobile apps. It allowed users to prompt to generate, run, and edit a complete application in their browsers. Bolt emphasized its speed and developer-centricity, focusing on technical users who wanted speed without sacrificing code control. Users could extend or refine applications through natural-language prompting or direct code edits, allowing quick iteration while maintaining flexibility. Users connected back-end functionality separately.

StackBlitz was founded in 2018 and was known for browser-based developer tooling. The company struggled to scale after raising a $7 million seed round; the board told the founders to find growth or shut down. A small team of 10 engineers within the company built Bolt in three months. Within its first weeks of launch, Bolt grew its active customer base to more than 14,000 and generated $1 million in ARR per week. A free open launch, strong buzz across developer communities, and active engagement on social media platforms such as Discord and Reddit fueled rapid adoption.

*Replit*

Replit, founded in 2016, began as a browser-based integrated development environment (IDE)—an app that provided tools and an intuitive interface to assist coding, typically used by professionals—aimed at making coding accessible for students and hobbyists. It evolved into a cloud-based, AI-powered software creation environment with built-in hosting and runtime, real-time collaboration, and integrations with GitHub. Users could connect their own code repositories, customize environments, and extend the platform. By late 2024, Replit had raised $210 million at a $1.16 billion valuation, had 58 employees, and had shifted its focus away from professional developers toward "developers of all levels." User count grew to 25 million by the end of the year with a $10 million revenue run rate.



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**Exhibit 1 (continued)**

Based in the Bay Area, Replit was unprofitable; revenue came from subscriptions, team and education plans, and usage-based fees. Central to Replit's appeal was its flexibility; users could write code manually with AI copiloting or let the agent autonomously create applications end-to-end. The dual mode distinguished it from competitors that focused on front-end generation and from no-code tools that limited code-level control. Replit's community powered viral adoption through shared projects, success stories, and a grassroots energy.

*V0 (Vercel)*

V0, launched by San Francisco-based Vercel in late 2023, was an AI-powered user interface (UI) and code generator designed for front-end developers and UI engineers. Positioned as a "pair programmer," it accelerated the creation of components, layouts, and full interfaces while producing clean, editable code that developers could download or sync with their own IDEs. It supported iterative refinement through re-prompting and could scaffold back-end elements by supporting application programming interfaces (APIs). It was powered by third-party LLMs, with the flexibility to swap among improved frontier models as they were released. By mid-2025, v0 had grown to around 100,000 users, driven largely by developers experimenting with AI-assisted UI workflows; it earned early praise for speed and code quality. Its development was supported by Vercel's $250 million Series D raise in May 2024, which valued the company at $3.25 billion.

V0 was introduced through Vercel's community channels, showcased at developer events, and embedded into the Vercel dashboard. Much of its distribution was community-driven, with developers sharing demos, prompts, and generated interfaces across social platforms.

Source: Casewriters, from: Lovable, "200M Series A Fundraise," tinyurl.com/tfj7zuhv; Mike Butcher, "Sweden's Lovable, an app-building AI platform, rakes in $15M after spectacular growth," TechCrunch, February 25, 2025, tinyurl.com/353jwcru; Lenny Rachitsky, "Building Lovable: $10M ARR in 60 days with 15 people | Anton Osika (co-founder and CEO)," podcast, March 9, 2025, tinyurl.com/8vm7vrad; Alistair Barr, "They were on the brink of failure. Then they seized on a new tech and hustled their startup into a success," Business Insider, May 18, 2025, tinyurl.com/w3pyt6ak; Connie Loizos, "After nine years of grinding, Replit finally found its market. Can it keep it?" TechCrunch, October 2, 2025, tinyurl.com/yrpkfvun; Charles Rollet, "Vibe coding startup Replit is projecting $1 billion in revenue by the end of 2026," Business Insider, October 20, 2025, tinyurl.com/55n9ds26; Aaron Cort, "Inside Replit's Breakout Growth: Lessons from $2.8M to $150M ARR," Craft Ventures, September 12, 2025, tinyurl.com/53ttcnhh; No Code MBA, "v0 vs Base44: Which AI App Builder Actually Deserves Your Time?" December 5, 2025, tinyurl.com/bdhcjtmb; Vercel, "Introducing the v0 composite model family," tinyurl.com/mr337bpc; and Bill Tanner, "Vercel ready to develop new AI product after $250 million funding round," Intelligent CIO, May 23, 2024, tinyurl.com/bd7bybu9; all accessed December 2025.



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**Exhibit 2a** Maor Shlomo LinkedIn Post—Tech Stack, May 15, 2025

Base44 is on track to make $100K profit this month.

89% of the cost still goes to model usage - with Claude 3.7 leading the charge and burning through my bank account.

I'm trying to keep things lean,
relying on tech instead of hiring wherever I can.

Here's the stack I'm using to build Base44:
---
Tech Stack:

Hosting & Servers – Render
*Can't recommend them enough*. No need for extra DevOps work or headcount — it just works. Also comes in handy when someone tries to DDoS Base44 every now and then.

Database – MongoDB. Super flexible, no painful migrations like you'd get with SQL.
Once you build enough infra on top, it's very smooth to work with.
Early on I did run into some performance issues — mostly due to not understanding Mongo's hosting tiers. (Tip: Don't try scaling on shared/virtual CPUs.)

Emails – SendGrid. Pricey, I think it's worth it for now. I do want to test Resend soon.

Payments – Stripe.
Still the easiest and most reliable option for SaaS.
Downsides:
- Failed payments are a black box - hard to debug
- Disputes are very expensive

Models – Using a mix.
Claude 3.7 is still the workhorse (via Bedrock, with fallback to Anthropic's own API).
But Gemini 2.5 Pro is catching up — I've seen it handle complex coding tasks with cleaner solutions.

The interesting thing is that I've stopped using OpenAI through the API, finding much better alternatives via Bedrock (AWS) / Vertex (Google) / Anthropic.

Logging and observability - Logfire (by Pydantic)
An up-and-coming alternative to Datadog. Much easier to use, and there's a great team behind it. So far I'm a happy customer.
—-
Operational Stack
Stripe Atlas – Set up the company through it. In my last startup, incorporation took weeks and $$$. Atlas is a game changer.

Brex – Love the product, makes managing finances effortless such that there's no need for a finance team (yet).

Cross-border payments are still very costly. I've tried setting up Wise to pay vendors outside of the US, but so far it has been more headache than help.

Community - Using Discord. Not sure I love it (maybe just a learning curve vs. Slack).

Internal Tools – I built everything else in Base44 itself:
- Docs
- User management
- Marketing content
- Coupon/credit system
- Hackathon coordination
- CRM for B2B deals
---
If I'm missing out on any other great tools that could help with automation or efficiency - drop a comment please.

Source: Maor Shlomo, LinkedIn, tinyurl.com/3pnwckep, accessed December 2025.



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**Exhibit 2b** Maor Shlomo LinkedIn Post—First Mention of Base44, February 17, 2025

Excited to share a project I've been working on lately.

Base44.com

Base44 is a moonshot experiment - helping everyone, technical or not, build software without coding, at all.

For the past decade or so - I've been obsessed with the idea of what possibilities will open up if everyone can build their own tools or apps - and lately it's seemed feasible enough to take a shot at it.

It's not the first tool aiming to allow people to build software using natural language,
But we're taking what I think is a very different and opinionated approach -
Every app in Base44 is created with a built-in DB, storage layer, authentication, analytics and countless integrations… or as our users like to call it - "batteries included".

This way - people can build happily without worrying what an API key means or how to set up this and that.

Since launching ~3 weeks ago, we went from (almost) 0 users to over 10k,
And people are building genuinely incredible stuff.
Some examples -

Ron, former restaurant manager - is building a SaaS platform for restaurants to manage invoices and expenses. Signed his first couple of customers within 2 weeks

René, South Africa, built a personal finance tracker app with AI-fused suggestions - and is growing every day with users from all over the world

Aravind (12!), US, has built his own version of a pokemon game.

—-

Give it a shot and tell me how it went.
It's been a blast watching people bring their ideas to life. I'd love to see what more people create with it.

Source: Maor Shlomo, LinkedIn, tinyurl.com/48h565wp, accessed December 2025.



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## **Exhibit 2c** Maor Shlomo LinkedIn Post—Reaching 20,000 Users, March 5, 2025

Yesterday, Base44 crossed 20k users and became profitable.

So I figured it's as good a time as any to share some of my lessons, learnings and mistakes.

Starting with the 0-> 1 part, or how I got my first couple of users -

While there are many ways to start,
and I've tried several of them throughout the years,
here's what I used for Base44 and what turned out to be my favorite:

👉 Build for a problem you understand better than anyone else.
👉 Find 3-5 people close to you who will live in your product daily.
---
Why a problem you know deeply?

Because it's really easy to build software right now.
And it's easy to come up with ideas that *should*, on paper, generate revenue.

Ideas, and software, are easier to copy - than a true deep understanding of a field.

Base44 is an idea I've obsessed over for years.
I've researched different ways of approaching it. I tried building MVPs throughout the years, all of them failed.

Recently, LLMs finally made Base44 feasible, but only after years of deep research and failed attempts.
---
Then comes the hardest part:

Your first users.

Sometimes I think it's better to find the users before the problem.
Because it's that hard.

You need 3-5 people who will gladly live inside your broken, unfinished, embarrassing v1.

How do you get them?
Start with friends or family.
People who want you to win.
People who'll tolerate your buggy mess, give you feedback, and keep showing up.

For Base44, I started with 3 close friends.
Solo founders.
Non-technical.
All needing to build their business quickly - and implement a product vision they have in mind.

This is the cheat code:
Sit with them, physically.
Watch them struggle. See exactly where your product breaks.

Fix it. Repeat.

For now - Forget scaling. Forget distribution.
Just make something that solves their problem better each day.

I stayed in this phase until i knew that I had >= 1 "vitality coefficient".
Meaning - that when i share the product with a new user, *on average*, this user will stay, use, and potentially introduce new users to the platform.

*On average* is important here - many users will not stay. and that's ok!

Source: Maor Shlomo, LinkedIn, https://tinyurl.com/mr3kdha3, accessed December 2025.



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**Exhibit 2d** Maor Shlomo LinkedIn Post—Enterprise Adoption, May 3, 2025

Over 10,000 companies are now using Base44 - and more than 1,300 of them are paying customers (the majority of customers are still individuals).

At first, most teams used Base44 to build MVPs and replace long PRDs with actual working products.

Instead of debating how a feature *might* look or feel,
you could just build it - in hours - and get real user feedback before opening Figma or writing a spec.

But Base44 has grown since then

With the rollout of Integrations - and more importantly, Backend Functions -
we're seeing entire products being built end-to-end on Base44.

Just in the past month, four startups I know of have raised seed or pre-seed funding based on products they built with Base44.

It's currently the fastest way to start iterating with users and gather early feedback.
The north star for me is also making sure it's the easiest way to scale your product to millions.

---

Back office systems are also going through a transformation.
It's easier than ever to build internal tooling.

The new Backend Functions feature unlocks the ability to create custom UIs on top of your data and APIs.
In fact, I run all of Base44's internal operations on apps built with Base44 -

- user management (dashboards, credit granting, upgrades, analytics),
- content marketing (this post was written using an AI-powered content creator with access to our materials),
- our documentation (docs[.]base44[.]com),
- even how we ran the Base4Good hackathon.

With the new integrations catalog (which hasn't even been properly announced yet :)) -
you can create private integrations so that every app uses your design systems and has built-in documentation on your company's APIs.

---

Lastly, one of the most surprising use cases for Base44 has been company-wide hackathons.
For the first time, you can run a hackathon where everyone in the company is a builder —
and you're not limited to the dev resources you can rally in a 24-hour window.

---

Base44 will soon introduce a dedicated Business Tier -
with SSO, team and enterprise plans,
private integrations, and eventually, dedicated deployments in your own virtual private cloud.

If you're a business user currently using Base44:
1. I'd love your feedback on what this tier should include.
2. Thank you. As a former "enterprise guy", can't tell you how exciting it is to "discover" a bottom-up B2B motion. Grateful to our early enterprise adopters 🙏

Source: Maor Shlomo, LinkedIn, https://tinyurl.com/3hz4rvfx, accessed December 2025.

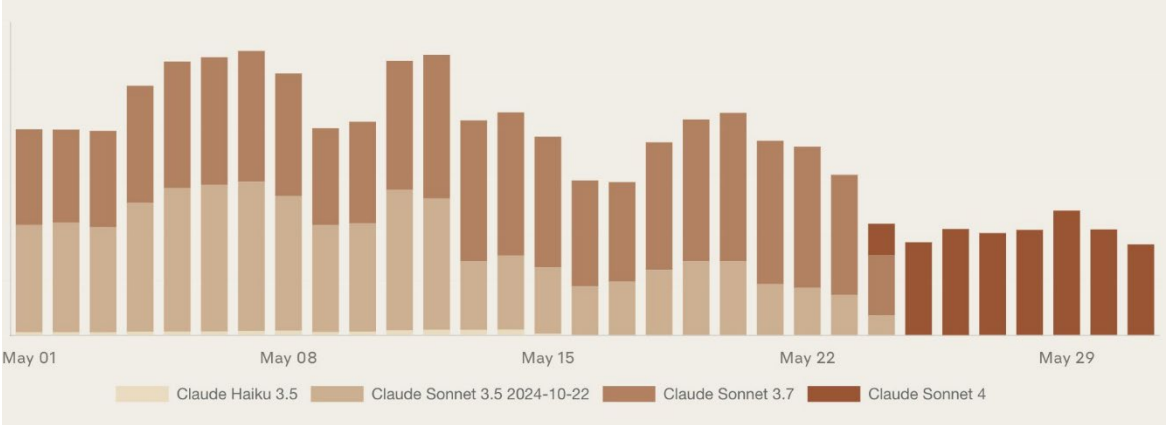


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**Exhibit 3** Base44's Anthropic Costs, May 2025




Source: Company documents.

**Exhibit 4** Code Completion and Development and Operations (DevOps) AI Tools by Website Traffic Growth, April-June 2025

| 12wk Change | 4/11 | 4/25 | 5/9 | 5/23 | 6/6 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Lovable | 409% | 322% | 207% | 148% | 72% |
| Cursor | 106% | 90% | 62% | 55% | 25% |
| Replit | 73% | 73% | 31% | 40% | 45% |
| Base44 | na | na | na | 950% | 29% |
| Bolt | -2% | -7% | 18% | 12% | 21% |
| Windsurf | 59% | 108% | 104% | 96% | 34% |
| V0 | 45% | 53% | 28% | 39% | 21% |
| Tabnine | 21% | 31% | 7% | 8% | 0% |
| Arize | 25% | 25% | 25% | 0% | 50% |
| All other | 38% | 45% | 37% | 28% | 59% |
| DevOps & Code Completion total | 108% | 105% | 76% | 66% | 41% |

Source: Similarweb, "AI Global - Global Sector Trends on Generative AI," September 12, 2025, tinyurl.com/445z9vhd, accessed November 2025.



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